Metadata Standards (Portfolio Edition)

Adapted from original professional work. Organization-specific names, examples, and implementation details have been generalized.

Purpose and scope

These metadata standards define consistent attributes for classifying, discovering, and governing technical documentation throughout its lifecycle. Unlike product and task taxonomies, metadata is nonhierarchical: it describes content rather than prescribing navigation.

The standards support reader-facing discovery and internal ownership, review, and maintenance. They do not replace the product taxonomy, task taxonomy, or information architecture.

Metadata model

Two complementary sets of attributes serve different needs:

- **Content discovery metadata** helps readers find and relate information
- **Content governance metadata** supports editorial operations and lifecycle management

Content discovery metadata

Field	Description	Example
Product	Product or component addressed	Management Console, Data Service, Agent
Task	Primary user goal	Learn, Deploy, Operate, Protect, Monitor, Automate
Concept	Core concept addressed	Database, volume, snapshot, host
Cloud provider	Applicable environment	AWS, Azure, Google Cloud, All
Audience	Intended reader	Administrator, developer, operator
Content type	Format	Conceptual overview, procedure, API reference, troubleshooting
Release	Version introducing or significantly changing the content	v2.1
Access level	Visibility	Public, Authenticated, Internal

Content governance metadata

Field	Purpose and illustrative values	Example
Content status	Lifecycle state	Draft, In Review, Current, Deprecated
Documentation owner	Team accountable for maintenance	Documentation, Product, Support
Technical review owner	Role responsible for technical approval	Platform SME, Security SME, Support SME
Last updated	Date of last publication or substantive review	

Application notes

- Use controlled values consistently across the content collection.
- Assign discovery attributes based on the primary reader need, not every possible tangential topic.
- Track ownership and review data in an internal content inventory rather than exposing it to readers.
- Review metadata when content scope, release applicability, or ownership changes.